The admiral's responses were brutally honest, indicating that the USA needed to aggressively recruit human sources: 'I think that generally across the board without being specific to India … I think we could say our human intelligence capacity is seriously limited. It is limited because of the tremendously expanded coverage that we are required to deal with in today's world. We are no longer looking at Russia and China as sort of the key places—we now have to be able to look at almost anywhere in the world for that kind of problem.'

Days after the nuclear test in Pokhran in May 1998, CIA analysts said it was a sign that the country's Hindu nationalist BJP-led NDA government believed it would be able to follow through with its long-range agenda to remake the country as a powerful Hindu state in accordance with party mythology about India's past, and if true, the party's widely popular security posture would help grow its political base and prepare the ground for more controversial domestic reforms down the road. American intelligence believed that the BJP was sending out mixed messages on its foreign policy priorities beyond the confines of South Asia, at least in part to keep foreign powers guessing about its intentions. Intelligence analysts argued that India had calculated that demonstrating its nuclear prowess made it a state that the international community could no longer ignore and provide it a permanent seat on the United Nations Security Council and a place at the table in various regional forums.

On the other hand, Admiral Jeremiah made certain recommendations, pointing out that few of them were India-specific. Although the classified report is still out of reach, a three-page sanitised version was released for public consumption. The panel headed by Jeremiah recommended that the US intelligence community must realign collection